

EU ports brace for long queues with new border checks

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【要点】

- ・ EU の新しい出入国管理システム(Entry/Exit System)の導入により、今夏、ドーバー海峡やスペイン・モロッコ間などの主要フェリー港で長時間の行列が発生する可能性がある。
- ・ 新システムでは非EU市民の指紋採取と写真撮影が必要となり、各乗客の処理時間が40秒から90秒に延び、ピーク時に混雑が深刻化する懸念がある。
- ・ 港湾施設の整備はほぼ完了しているものの、生体認証チェックを行う国内ITシステムが一部国でまだ完全には稼働していない。
- ・ フェリー港の混乱は全欧州ではなく、ドーバー・カレー回廊やスペイン南部からモロッコへの航路など特定の繁忙地点に集中すると予想される。
- ・ EUから7月中旬から8月中旬の主要な旅行時期に新システムの真価が試されることになる。

【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By MARTINA SAPIO SNEAK PEEK
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SNEAK PEEK

— Holidaymakers could face hourslong queues at some ports this summer, as Europe's main ferry gateways grapple with the rollout of the EU's new Entry/Exit System.

— Europe's rail industry pleads to preserve a dedicated rail research partnership in the next EU budget, warning that ending the program would hand an advantage to foreign competitors.

— Volkswagen, Mercedes-Benz and Stellantis have joined a coalition urging Brussels to overhaul its clean-tech state aid rules, saying Europe needs stronger support to compete with China and the United States.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

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DRIVING THE DAY

ENTRY/EXIT SYSTEM PUTS EU GATEWAYS TO THE TEST: Holidaymakers could face hourslong queues at some of Europe's busiest ferry crossings this summer as the rollout of the EU's new Entry/Exit

System puts pressure on key passenger gateways, the European Sea Ports Organisation warned.

Not every port: ESPO told Martina the disruption is expected to be concentrated at a handful of busy passenger gateways—not across all of Europe’s ports. The biggest concerns are the Dover-Calais corridor and ferry links between southern Spain and Morocco, where millions of passengers travel during the summer peak. By contrast, ports with mainly transit cruise traffic are expected to see far less disruption.

Under the new rules, non-EU citizens are fingerprinted and photographed in lieu of traditional passport stamping at the border. Commission President Ursula von der Leyen last week acknowledged the Entry/Exit System is experiencing “technical problems” after airports reported queues of up to five hours and growing operational disruption.

Different outlooks: While Dover has already warned of a potential “critical incident” unless France and the EU show greater flexibility, Spain’s Port of Algeciras said it expects the necessary technology to be operational. The real test, however, will come during the busiest travel windows — around July 15, July 21 and mid-August — when millions of passengers travel between Spain and Morocco.

The bottleneck: According to ESPO, ports have largely completed the infrastructure investments needed for EES, but the national IT systems required to carry out automated biometric checks are not yet fully operational in some countries. Some border authorities are therefore processing travelers manually, increasing checks from roughly 40 seconds to around 90 seconds per vehicle — a seemingly small change that can quickly snowball during peak traffic.

Built for flow: Ferry terminals such as Dover “were not built for that system,” ESPO said. Their layouts are designed to keep vehicles moving continuously onto ferries, with very little spare capacity inside the port. Doubling border processing times risks quickly breaking that rhythm, sending queues out of the terminals and onto surrounding roads.

A more pragmatic rollout: Rather than suspending the Entry/Exit System altogether, ESPO wants authorities to make greater use of the regulation’s built-in emergency mechanism, which allows biometric border checks to be temporarily suspended when traffic congestion becomes severe. The problem, the association argues, is that the safeguard can currently only be activated once queues have already become critical. Allowing authorities to trigger it earlier would help prevent a gridlock rather than simply react to it.

RAIL

RAIL SECTOR LOBBIES TO SAVE EU R&D PROGRAM: Europe’s rail industry is making a last-minute push to preserve a dedicated rail research partnership in the next EU budget, warning that ending the program would fragment innovation efforts and hand an advantage to heavily subsidized Chinese competitors.

In a joint letter seen by Martina, four of Europe’s largest rail associations — CER, UNIFE, EIM and UIP — urged the Commission to establish a new, standalone Railway Joint Undertaking — an EU public-private research and innovation partnership entity for the rail sector — under the next EU research framework.

The letter was sent on Monday to Industry Commissioner Stéphane Séjourné, Transport Commissioner Apostolos Tzitzikostas, Research Commissioner Ekaterina Zaharieva, Budget Commissioner Piotr Serafin, Tech Commissioner Henna Virkkunen and Cohesion Commissioner Raffaele Fitto.

The warning: The current Europe's Rail Joint Undertaking, launched in 2021 as the successor to Shift2Rail, is due to expire with the current Multiannual Financial Framework. The sector argues that discontinuing it would fragment European rail research, slow the deployment of common technologies and weaken the bloc's industrial base just as it seeks to boost competitiveness, military mobility and strategic autonomy.

The message: "A dedicated Railway Joint Undertaking is essential to maintain Europe's technological leadership, competitiveness and industrial strength," said UNIFE Director General Enno Wiebe. "Continuing it will support jobs, exports and Europe's strategic autonomy by keeping railway innovation and manufacturing in Europe," a point the industry says is becoming increasingly urgent as Chinese competitors benefit from substantial public support for rail research and development.

CARS

CARMAKERS JOIN PUSH TO REWRITE EU STATE AID RULES: Volkswagen, Mercedes-Benz, Stellantis and nearly 50 other companies and industry groups are urging the European Commission to overhaul its clean-tech state aid framework, arguing the current rules are no longer fit to compete with China and the United States.

In a letter sent to the Commission on Monday and seen by our colleague Aude van den Hove, the coalition — including carmakers, battery manufacturers, charging companies and clean-tech associations — argues that Brussels should rewrite the Clean Industrial State Aid Framework, the rulebook governing how EU countries can subsidize clean-tech projects.

Bankability is everything: "We need to make manufacturing aid genuinely bankable," the organizations said, arguing that public support should make it easier for companies to attract private investors and lenders by reducing financial risk. That is "a strict precondition for achieving a real incentive effect and crowding in private capital."

Output-based aid: The companies want the Commission to allow EU countries to support manufacturers based on their output, for example through a fixed premium per battery cell, kilogram of renewable hydrogen or solar module. The current framework doesn't allow for this type of output-based production support, even though it is essential for scaling up manufacturing. The signatories acknowledge that introducing such aid would likely require a broader revision of EU state aid rules.

Made in Europe: The signatories want companies with "a substantial EU-based governance and operational footprint" to be prioritized for state aid. They say this would align with the principles of the Industrial Accelerator Act and ensure public support benefits companies with a long-term strategic commitment to Europe. They also back safeguards on foreign ownership or influence, while stressing that "trusted international partners who invest meaningfully in Europe" should remain eligible.

Switching gears: For the signatories, CISAF "was designed for a world where the main competitive threat came from within the single market." That is no longer the case, they argue, as Europe now faces growing global competition for clean-tech investment. With the Electrification Action Plan due on July 17, they say now is the time to "switch gears."

EU COUNTRIES SEEK BIGGER SAY ON 'MADE IN EUROPE' RULES: EU governments want greater control over which non-EU countries qualify as "trusted partners" under the Industrial Accelerator Act, a key decision that will shape which foreign-made vehicle components can benefit from the bloc's proposed "Made in Europe" procurement rules.

The change: According to a Council compromise text obtained by POLITICO, member countries want decisions on adding or removing trusted partners to be taken through implementing acts, giving national governments a formal say instead of leaving the decision largely in the hands of the European Commission.

Big obstacle: The definition of “Made in Europe” is expected to underpin a series of transport files, including the proposed greening of corporate fleets regulation , meaning negotiations on those dossiers are unlikely to progress until governments and lawmakers agree on which third countries can be treated as equivalent to EU suppliers.

MORE JOB CUTS LOOM AT PORSCHE: German carmaker Porsche is considering cutting 4,000 jobs and merging divisions in an effort to cut costs, according to German media reports .

SHIPPING

FIRST RED SEA SHIP ATTACK IN OVER A YEAR: A cargo vessel came under attack in the Red Sea on Sunday, marking the first reported assault on a commercial ship in the corridor in more than a year and raising fresh concerns over maritime security.

What happened: According to the U.K. Maritime Trade Operations, armed assailants in a small boat opened fire on a bulk carrier around 30 nautical miles southwest of Yemen’s Houthi-controlled port of Hodeida. The vessel’s onboard security team returned fire before the attackers withdrew to a larger mother ship.

AVIATION

ICAO RENEWS WARNING OVER EU AVIATION ETS PLANS: The U.N.’s aviation agency has renewed its call for governments to avoid “duplicative” regional climate measures, in a fresh signal to Brussels as the Commission weighs extending the EU Emissions Trading System to all departing flights, including to destinations outside the bloc.

The message: In a statement released Monday, the International Civil Aviation Organization stressed that the global Carbon Offsetting and Reduction Scheme for International Aviation, or CORSIA, should remain the cornerstone of efforts to cut emissions from international flights. It warned against “duplicative intervention through national or regional measures in a fragmented manner,” arguing that countries should align climate policies through ICAO to preserve a level playing field for airlines.

Why now: The intervention comes just weeks after ICAO wrote to the European Commission urging it not to extend the EU ETS to all flights departing Europe. Brussels is considering the move as part of the upcoming review of the aviation ETS, due later this month , arguing that CORSIA alone is insufficient to meet the bloc’s climate objectives.

Headlines

Here’s a recap of yesterday’s news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

Porsche plans 4,000 further job cuts in major restructuring

By Ferdinand Knapp · Jul 06, 2026, 01:58 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Document: EU capitals seek greater say over ‘Made in Europe’ partners

EU countries want a formal role in deciding which third countries qualify — or are excluded — under the Industrial Accelerator Act’s “trusted partner” regime.

By Francesca Micheletti, Sebastian Starcevic · Jul 06, 2026, 01:53 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Document: EU countries want 'buy European' quotas for green steel

By Ben Makuch, Sebastian Starcevic · Jul 06, 2026, 01:25 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

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